

Disputed Card Transactions

Intake, triage, investigation and resolution workflow

TRAINING USE ONLY — This is a fictional policy created for a learning project. All names, thresholds, deadlines and procedures are invented. This document is not a real bank policy and must not be used to guide actual financial decisions or claim regulatory compliance.

Document control

Field	Value
Fictional organisation	Learning Bank Ltd. (invented for training)
Policy ID	LB-POL-014
Version	1.0
Status	Active in the simulated knowledge base
Effective date	1 January 2026 (fictional)
Review date	1 January 2027 (fictional)
Document type	Operations policy
Region metadata	UK (sample metadata only; not a statement of UK law)

Purpose

This sample policy gives a fictional operations team a consistent process for receiving, categorising, investigating and closing disputed card-transaction cases. It is designed to provide realistic-looking source material for demonstrating document loading, chunking, metadata filtering, semantic retrieval and grounded question answering.

1. Scope and key terms

This workflow applies to simulated debit-card and credit-card transaction disputes submitted through the fictional bank's mobile app, telephone support or branch team. It covers the internal case-handling process from first report to documented outcome. It does not define legal rights, real-world liability, or statutory time limits.

Key terms

Term	Meaning in this sample policy
Disputed transaction	A card transaction the customer says is incorrect, unrecognised or not delivered as expected.
Case ID	A unique internal reference used to track a dispute from intake through closure.
Evidence	Information used by a reviewer, such as transaction details, receipts, correspondence or a merchant response.
Provisional status	A temporary case status used while evidence is being gathered; it is not a final decision.
Resolution	A documented outcome, rationale and customer communication for the case.

2. Intake and minimum information

The intake colleague creates a case record and captures only information needed to identify and investigate the transaction.

- Customer reference or internal customer ID.
- Transaction reference, where available; otherwise date, approximate time, amount, currency and merchant name.
- Dispute reason in the customer's own words, plus a selected category if one clearly applies.
- Whether the customer recognises the merchant and whether they have already contacted the merchant, if relevant.
- Preferred contact channel and any accessibility or communication requirement relevant to case updates.

Never include a full card number, CVV, PIN, online-banking password or one-time passcode in free-text notes, document metadata or an LLM prompt. Use approved internal references instead.

3. Dispute categories and first checks

Category	First checks	Initial routing
Unrecognised transaction	Confirm transaction details and ask whether the card or device may be shared or used by an authorised user.	Route promptly to the card-security review queue if fraud is suspected.
Duplicate charge	Compare amounts, merchant identifiers, timestamps and whether one item is still pending.	Route to transaction operations; do not assume matching amounts prove a duplicate.
Goods or service issue	Record the expected service, delivery date, cancellation details and merchant contact if available.	Route to merchant-dispute review.
Cash withdrawal issue	Record ATM location, date, amount requested and amount received, if known.	Route to cash-operations investigation.
Pending transaction	Confirm the transaction is pending and explain that pending items may change before posting.	Check status before opening a full dispute investigation.

4. Investigation workflow and internal targets

The timeframes below are invented service targets used only in this training document. They are not legal, regulatory or contractual deadlines. Business days are measured using the fictional team's working calendar.

Stage	Target	Required action and record
1. Register	Day 0	Create a case ID; record the transaction reference and dispute reason; assign the initial category.
2. Acknowledge	Within 1 business day	Confirm receipt, provide the case ID, explain the next step and identify missing information.
3. Validate	Within 3 business days	Check that minimum information is present, review available transaction data and route to the correct queue.
4. Initial review	Within 5 business days	Review available evidence, identify gaps and record the current status, owner and next action.
5. Investigate	Target: 15 business days	Obtain relevant internal or merchant evidence, assess it against the case facts and keep a decision trail.
6. Update	Every 5 business days while waiting	If external evidence is outstanding, send a progress update and record the next follow-up date.
7. Close	After a decision is approved	Record the outcome and rationale, communicate it to the customer and close or hand off any follow-up task.

5. Evidence and decision quality

The reviewer should use the available evidence, distinguish verified facts from assumptions, and document why the evidence supports the proposed outcome.

- Compare the disputed transaction with the transaction record; do not infer fraud solely from an unfamiliar merchant name.
- Review receipts, cancellation confirmations, merchant correspondence or ATM information only when relevant to the dispute category.
- Record the source and date of material evidence. If evidence is missing or contradictory, document the gap rather than guessing.
- A second reviewer must approve any case marked high impact or escalated under Section 6.
- The final message must explain the decision in plain language and must not disclose another customer's data or internal security controls.

6. Escalation rules

Trigger	Required response
Customer reports an unrecognised transaction and suspected card compromise	Route immediately to the simulated card-security queue; follow the separate fictional card-safety playbook and avoid promising an outcome.
Potential exposure of credentials or sensitive data	Stop copying the information into notes, preserve the approved case reference, and escalate to the designated security contact.
Case exceeds the 15-business-day training target	Escalate to the disputes lead, document the reason for delay, identify the next action and continue progress updates every 5 business days.
Evidence conflicts or the proposed outcome is unclear	Keep the case open, record the unresolved question and request a second review. Do not invent missing facts.

7. Outcomes and case closure

Every case must end with a recorded status. The status describes the workflow result and should not be treated as a legal conclusion.

Resolved - adjustment approved

The reviewer found sufficient support under the fictional policy to recommend an adjustment. Record the amount, approval reference and expected processing step, if applicable.

Resolved - no adjustment

The available evidence did not support an adjustment under this fictional workflow. Record the specific evidence considered and explain the result without blaming the customer.

More information required

The case cannot be decided with the available evidence. Specify the information required, who is expected to provide it and the next follow-up date.

Referred to specialist team

The case requires card-security, cash-operations, data-security or disputes-lead review. Record the receiving queue and handoff reference.

8. Frequently asked questions

How quickly should the customer receive an acknowledgement?

Within 1 business day of intake, under this fictional policy. The acknowledgement should include the case ID, next step and any known missing information.

When should the initial review be completed?

Within 5 business days of intake. The reviewer should assess the available evidence, record gaps and confirm ownership of the next action.

What if the case is waiting for merchant evidence?

Record the outstanding request and follow-up date, then provide a progress update every 5 business days until the evidence arrives or the case is escalated.

Does an unfamiliar merchant name prove fraud?

No. The reviewer should compare transaction details and assess the customer's report. An unfamiliar name alone is not enough to conclude that fraud occurred.

What must never be included in the case notes?

A full card number, CVV, PIN, online-banking password or one-time passcode. Use approved internal references instead.

What happens if a case passes the 15-business-day target?

Escalate it to the disputes lead, document the delay and next action, and keep the customer updated every 5 business days while the case remains open.

Can an automated assistant make the final decision based only on retrieved text?

No. In this learning scenario, retrieval can surface relevant procedure text, but a real case decision would require authorised workflow controls and evidence from approved systems. A generated answer must not invent transaction facts.

9. Example cases for training

Example	Question	Policy-grounded response
A. Duplicate charge	A customer sees two similar charges at the same merchant. What should happen first?	Compare amount, merchant identifiers, timestamps and pending/posted status. Similar amounts alone do not prove a duplicate.
B. Delayed evidence	A merchant has not replied and the case is on day 10. What is expected?	Record the evidence request and next follow-up date; provide a progress update every 5 business days while waiting.
C. Unrecognised payment	A customer says they do not recognise a card transaction and suspects compromise. Where is it routed?	Immediately to the fictional card-security queue; do not promise the final outcome.

End of sample policy. This document exists solely to test a learning RAG pipeline. If a question asks about real banking rules or legal deadlines, the assistant should say this sample does not establish them and should require an authoritative source.